

KENDALL CHRISTIAN SCHOOL BOARD

Governance & Board Development Committee

Governance Review & Committee Charter Recommendations

Prepared for Committee Review and Refinement

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Purpose

The Governance & Board Development Committee was tasked by the Board of Trustees to review the governing documents of Kendall Christian School and Christchurch Miami and to develop committee charter recommendations in support of the school's long-term governance, strategic planning, financial alignment, advancement, and institutional sustainability.

This report is intended as a working draft for Committee discussion, refinement, and eventual recommendation to the Board of Trustees. It is not intended to create unnecessary bureaucracy or an excessive number of policies. Rather, it is designed to set up a clear and practical governance framework that supports the school's mission and future growth.

Executive Summary

Following review of the Kendall Christian School Constitution and the governing documents of Kendall Continuing Presbyterian Church, the Committee concludes that the current governance framework remains fundamentally sound.

The Committee does not recommend significant revisions to either the School Constitution or the Church Bylaws at this time. The governing documents continue to provide an adequate foundation for the school's mission, authority, oversight, and relationship to the Church.

The greater opportunity lies in strengthening governance systems, leadership development, succession planning, strategic oversight, committee effectiveness, financial alignment, advancement capacity, and institutional continuity.

The Committee therefore recommends formalizing charters for the three principal Board workstreams:

- Governance & Board Development
- Strategic Planning & Financial Alignment
- Advancement & Development

Governance Review

Review of the Kendall Christian School Constitution

The Constitution continues to provide a solid governance foundation for Kendall Christian School.

The Committee found that the Constitution clearly establishes:

- The school's biblical and Reformed theological foundation.
- The purpose of providing quality Christian education.

- The partnership of the home, Church, and School in the education of children.
- Kendall Christian School as an organization and ministry of Kendall Continuing Presbyterian Church.
- The jurisdiction and ultimate authority of the Session.
- The delegated duties, powers, and authorities of the Board of Trustees.
- The Board's responsibilities for programs, finances, property, personnel, policy, and reporting.

Committee Conclusion

The Constitution remains functional and continues to provide sufficient authority and direction for the governance of Kendall Christian School.

Recommendation

No substantive constitutional amendments are recommended at this time. Future consideration may be given to modernizing terminology, clarifying officer responsibilities, and aligning supporting governance documents with the Constitution, provided any changes are necessary and approved through the proper authority.

Review of the Kendall Continuing Presbyterian Church Bylaws

The Committee reviewed the Church Bylaws as they relate to the establishment, operation, and oversight of educational ministries.

The Bylaws clearly provide authority for the Corporation to:

- Establish, operate, and maintain educational institutions.
- Emphasize Christian truth in the teaching of those institutions.
- Own, acquire, hold, and steward real and personal property.
- Support ministry activities consistent with the Church's biblical and Reformed purpose.

Committee Conclusion

The Church Bylaws adequately support the existence and operation of Kendall Christian School as a ministry of the Church and provide the necessary corporate authority for the stewardship of its property and institutional responsibilities.

Recommendation

No substantive revisions to the Church Bylaws are recommended at this time as part of this review.

Governance Findings

1. Build Systems, Not Dependence on Individuals

The school should continue developing governance systems that provide continuity, regardless of changes in Board membership, School administration, or Church leadership.

2. Strengthen the Board of Development

Future governance work should include Board orientation, continuing education, succession planning, committee effectiveness, and clearly documented expectations for Board service.

3. Align Governance with Strategy and Finances

Strategic priorities should be supported by realistic timelines, measurable outcomes, and multi-year financial planning.

4. Preserve Mission Alignment

All governance initiatives should reinforce the School's Christian mission, Reformed foundation, and relationship with Christchurch Miami.

5. Develop Only the Policies That Are Needed

The Board should avoid producing an excessive number of stand-alone policies. Policies should be developed only when they address a demonstrated governance, operational, legal, financial, accreditation, or risk-management need.

Mission Statement for Future Consideration

The following mission statement is offered for future discussion and refinement. It is not presented as part of this initial governance review:

Kendall Christian School exists to glorify God by partnering with families and ChristchurchMiami to provide Christ-centered, biblically grounded education that develops the whole child academically, spiritually, socially, and morally, equipping students to love God, serve others, think Christianly, and faithfully engage their church, community, and world for the glory of Jesus Christ.

Committee Charter Recommendations

The following charters are presented as recommended working drafts for each committee to review, edit, develop, and return to the Board for approval. The permanent provisions of each charter should remain stable, while current priority deliverables may be updated as the Board's needs evolve.

Governance & Board Development Committee Charter

Purpose

To strengthen Board governance practices, leadership development, succession planning, committee effectiveness, and institutional continuity in support of the mission and long-term sustainability of Kendall Christian School.

Responsibilities

- Review the School Constitution, relevant Church governing documents, and other foundational governance documents.
- Recommend governance improvements that are consistent with the authority of the Session and the responsibilities of the Board.
- Develop, maintain, and periodically review the Board Governance Manual.
- Develop and maintain a structured Board orientation process.
- Support Board recruitment, leadership development, and succession planning.
- Recommend a Board skills and experience matrix to help with future recruitment.
- Develop and review committee charter templates.
- Review Board and committee effectiveness and recommend improvements.
- Recommend governance education, workshops, and continuing development opportunities.
- Maintain an annual Board calendar that shows recurring governance responsibilities and decision points.
- Promote governance practices that build systems rather than dependence on individual leaders.

Membership

- Members shall be appointed by the Board Chair, subject to any applicable Board requirements.
- The Committee should consist of at least three Board members whenever practical.
- The Head of School may take part as an administrative resource, except when the Committee is addressing matters requiring independent Board deliberation.
- Other non-Board advisors may be invited as needed.
- The Committee Chair shall be designated by the Board Chair or elected by the Committee, as determined by the Board.

Meetings

- The Committee shall meet as needed to fulfill its responsibilities, but ordinarily not less than quarterly while active deliverables are pending.
- Meeting agendas and supporting materials should be distributed in advance whenever practical.
- The Committee shall maintain a written record of recommendations and assigned follow-up items.

Authority

The Committee serves as an advisory capacity to the Board and has no independent authority to bind the School, the Board, the Church, the Corporation, or the Session. Recommendations requiring action shall be presented to the Board and, where applicable, to the Session.

Reporting and Accountability

- Provide progress reports to the Board at proper intervals.
- Present recommendations in writing when Board action is requested.
- Review the charter periodically and recommend revisions when necessary.
- Track current deliverables as Not Started, In Progress, or Complete.

Current Priority Deliverables (2026–2027)

- ☐ Complete review of the Kendall Christian School Constitution.
- ☐ Complete review of the Kendall Continuing Presbyterian Church Bylaws.
- ☐ Finalize committee charter templates for the three primary Board workstreams.
- ☐ Develop or improve the Board Governance Manual.
- ☐ Develop a Board Orientation Framework.
- ☐ Develop a Board Recruitment and Succession Planning Framework.
- ☐ Recommend a Governance Workshop for Board members.
- ☐ Develop an Annual Board Calendar.
- ☐ Incorporate the previously completed Conflict of Interest Policy into the Board Governance Manual.

Future Matters for Consideration

- ☐ Board self-assessment process.
- ☐ Committee effectiveness review process.
- ☐ Board continuing education framework.
- ☐ Governance glossary and definitions appendix.

Strategic Planning & Financial Alignment Committee Charter

Purpose

To assist the Board in ensuring that the school's mission, strategic priorities, financial resources, and organizational capacity remain aligned through realistic planning, measurable outcomes, and responsible long-term stewardship.

Responsibilities

- Review and recommend changes to the existing Strategic Plan.
- Evaluate whether current strategic priorities stay mission-aligned, realistic, and appropriately sequenced.
- Identify near-term initiatives that can reasonably be advanced within available capacity and resources.
- Distinguish between short-term priorities, medium-term initiatives, and long-term aspirations.
- Coordinate strategic planning with multi-year financial planning.
- Evaluate the financial implications of proposed strategic initiatives.
- Recommend measurable Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) for Board oversight.
- Develop a practical dashboard or reporting framework for monitoring progress.
- Review enrollment, program growth, staffing, facility, and operational assumptions that materially affect strategy.
- Identify risks, dependencies, and resource constraints that could affect implementation.
- Recommend adjustments when strategic priorities and financial capacity are not aligned.

Membership

- Members shall be appointed by the Board Chair.
- The Committee should include Board members with strategic, financial, operational, educational, or organizational experience.
- The Head of School and administrative or financial staff may participate as resources.
- Other non-Board advisors may be invited as needed.

Meetings

- The Committee shall meet as needed during the strategic review and financial alignment process.
- The Committee should coordinate with the Finance Committee or Treasurer when financial modeling is needed.
- The Committee shall maintain a record of assumptions, decisions, and recommended priorities.

Authority

The Committee serves in an advisory capacity to the Board and does not independently approve strategic plans, budgets, capital expenditures, staffing commitments, or institutional obligations.

Reporting and Accountability

- Provide periodic progress reports to the Board.
- Present recommended strategic priorities and financial alignment findings in writing.
- Identify any matters requiring Board decision or referral to another committee.
- Coordinate with the Advancement & Development Committee when strategic initiatives require philanthropic support.

Current Priority Deliverables (2026–2027)

- ☐ Review the existing Strategic Plan.
- ☐ Identify realistic near-term strategic initiatives.
- ☐ Develop a recommended sequence and timeline for strategic priorities.
- ☐ Align strategic initiatives with a multi-year financial plan.
- ☐ Identify measurable KPIs.
- ☐ Recommend a Board-level KPI dashboard.
- ☐ Establish a practical strategic progress reporting process.

Future Matters for Consideration

- ☐ Enrollment sustainability framework.
- ☐ Long-range facilities planning.
- ☐ Program expansion review.
- ☐ Periodic strategic plan refresh cycle.
- ☐ Scenario planning for significant changes in enrollment, staffing, facilities, or funding.

Advancement & Development Committee Charter

Purpose

To assist the Board in strengthening the long-term financial sustainability and growth of Kendall Christian School through advancement strategy, donor engagement, philanthropic development, campaign readiness, and responsible preparation for future capital initiatives.

Responsibilities

- Recommend a comprehensive advancement and development strategy aligned with the school's mission and strategic priorities.
- Clarify the respective roles of the Board, Head of School, staff, consultants, volunteers, and Church leadership in advancement activities.
- Assess the School's current development infrastructure, systems, records, communications, and donor stewardship practices.
- Develop an Annual Fund framework and recommendations for donor participation.
- Support donor identification, cultivation, engagement, solicitation, acknowledgment, and stewardship strategies.
- Recommend approaches for alumni, parent, grandparent, church member, foundation, and community engagement.
- Evaluate the School's readiness for major gifts and capital fundraising.
- Assess philanthropic capacity and the availability of campaign leadership.
- Support development of a compelling and mission-centered case for support.
- Evaluate future capital project opportunities in coordination with the Board, administration, Church leadership, and professional advisors.
- Assist the Board in evaluating the proposed middle school expansion and potential two-story facility.
- Ensure that capital planning includes a documented educational needs assessment, enrollment analysis, facility needs assessment, preliminary scope, realistic cost estimates, funding assumptions, and achievable timelines.
- Recommend whether and when professional campaign counsel, feasibility study support, architectural planning, or other specialized expertise should be engaged.
- Develop recommendations for campaign readiness, including a quiet phase, leadership gifts, donor communications, public launch, reporting, and stewardship.
- Evaluate the long-term operating impact of a capital project, not merely the construction cost.
- Coordinate with the Strategic Planning & Financial Alignment Committee to ensure that advancement initiatives and capital plans are financially and strategically aligned.

Membership

- Members shall be appointed by the Board Chair.
- The Committee should include Board members with development, finance, communications, relationship-building, strategic planning, or project experience.
- The Head of School and advancement or administrative personnel may participate as operational resources.
- Jacky Donate or other development professionals may provide operational input or professional guidance as appropriate.
- Other non-Board advisors may be invited as needed.

Meetings

- The Committee shall meet as needed to advance its assigned deliverables.
- During active campaign-readiness or capital-planning periods, the Committee may meet more frequently.
- The Committee shall maintain written records of assumptions, recommendations, donor-development priorities, and assigned responsibilities.

Authority

The Committee serves in an advisory and oversight-support capacity to the Board. It does not independently authorize fundraising campaigns, approve construction projects, commit the School or Church financially, engage contractors, approve contracts, or bind the Corporation. Operational fundraising activities remain under School administration within approved plans, budgets, and authority. Any capital project or campaign requiring Board, corporate, or Session approval shall be submitted through the proper governance process.

Reporting and Accountability

- Provide regular progress reports to the Board.
- Present major recommendations in writing.
- Coordinate closely with School administration and development personnel.
- Coordinate with the Strategic Planning & Financial Alignment Committee on funding capacity, operating impact, and timelines.
- Identify matters that require Board action, Session action, professional consultation, or formation of a separate project-specific task force.

Current Priority Deliverables (2026–2027)

- ☐ Develop an Advancement Strategy Framework.
- ☐ Assess current Development Infrastructure.
- ☐ Develop an Annual Fund Framework.
- ☐ Develop a Donor Engagement and Stewardship Strategy.

- ☐ Conduct a Capital Project Readiness Assessment.
- ☐ Conduct a preliminary Campaign Feasibility Review.
- ☐ Develop a documented needs assessment for the proposed middle school expansion.
- ☐ Develop preliminary enrollment, educational, facility, and program assumptions for the proposed two-story structure.
- ☐ Establish a preliminary project cost range and funding model, currently estimated in the range of approximately \$5 million, subject to professional validation.
- ☐ Develop accurate and realistic planning milestones and timelines.
- ☐ Develop a Five-Year Advancement Roadmap.

Future Matters for Consideration

- ☐ Formal feasibility study.
- ☐ Campaign counsel selection.
- ☐ Case for support.
- ☐ Capital campaign plan and quiet-phase strategy.
- ☐ Major gifts program.
- ☐ Gift acceptance policy, when needed.
- ☐ Naming opportunities policy, when needed.
- ☐ Endowment or long-term investment strategy, when institutional capacity supports it.
- ☐ Donor recognition and long-term stewardship framework.

Governance Roadmap

Phase 1 — Governance Foundation (2026–2027)

- Constitution and Church Bylaws review.
- Committee charter adoption.
- Board Governance Manual development.
- Board orientation framework.
- Board recruitment and succession planning.
- Annual Board calendar.

Phase 2 — Strategic Alignment (2027–2028)

- Strategic Plan review.
- Identification and sequencing of realistic priorities.
- Multi-year financial alignment.
- KPI dashboard and progress reporting.
- Advancement strategy and Annual Fund framework.
- Capital project readiness and preliminary feasibility work.

Phase 3 — Future Readiness (2028–2030)

- Formal capital campaign planning, if approved.
- Middle school facility expansion planning.
- Leadership continuity.
- Long-term facilities and sustainability planning.
- Campaign implementation and donor stewardship, if authorized.

Committee Recommendation

The Governance & Board Development Committee should consider recommending that the Board:

- Receive the Governance Review Report.
- Approve the Governance & Board Development Committee Charter.
- Approve the Strategic Planning & Financial Alignment Committee Charter.
- Approve the Advancement & Development Committee Charter.
- Direct the Governance Committee to continue development of the Board Governance Manual.
- Continue implementation of the Institutional Strengthening Framework through the established Board workstreams.

Guiding Principle

“The purpose of governance is not to create bureaucracy, but to establish the minimum governance framework necessary to provide clarity, accountability, continuity, and mission alignment. Governance systems should support the mission of the school and serve future generations of students, families, faculty, and leaders.”

Respectfully Submitted, 

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Governance & Board Development Committee
Kendall Christian School Board of Trustees